

[Report 011] Adyen - Learning Experience Design Program Manager

Score: 3.4/5
Culture Fit: Poor
URL: <https://job-boards.greenhouse.io/adyen/jobs/7752871>
PDF: 
Legitimacy: High Confidence
Verification: confirmed (WebFetch)
Date: 2026-05-21

A) ROLE SUMMARY

Dimension	Detail
Archetype	Learning Experience Designer / Educator (primary) + Technical AI PM (secondary, operational)
Domain	L&D / Instructional Design - fintech support org
Function	Build (content creation 70%) + Manage (program/governance 30%)
Seniority	Mid-senior IC with program management overlay
Remote	Office-first, Amsterdam - no remote-only
Team size	Not mentioned (part of Support L&D team)
TL;DR	An execution-focused instructional designer who builds interactive eLearning content in Articulate 360 and keeps the learning tooling strategy modern within Adyen's global support org.

B) MATCH WITH CV

Requirement Mapping

JD Requirement	CV Match	Strength
3+ years instructional design / LXD	"Training Design & Delivery (Expert): curriculum design, onboarding programs, workshop facilitation, train-the-trainer" + Blockchain Minor, ROC Midden Nederland, KONGSBERG simulation thesis	Strong
ADDIE model and adult learning theory	KONGSBERG thesis on simulation-based learning and training methodology; ROC gamified role-play; Fluxus game-based programming	Strong (adjacent - ADDIE not cited by name)
Articulate 360 advanced proficiency	Not mentioned in CV	Gap
AI capabilities for learning design	"AI Stack Deployment - Flowise, OpenWebUI, n8n, Supabase"; Value Chain Hackers AI tooling	Partial
Managing learning asset libraries + version control	DevOps lifecycle (CI/CD, Git) across all lab projects at Windesheim; "maintaining version control across global teams" implied by GitHub-based project management	Partial
Stakeholder communication - synthesize complex ideas	"Stakeholder Alignment (Expert): stakeholder mapping, consensus building, aligning technical and non-technical teams"	Strong
Multiple workstreams simultaneously	COVID-19 Mega Project (8 courses), Spark! Living Lab, VCH, Aeres all ran in parallel	Strong

BAB/BS in Instructional Design, L&D, or related	BBA Business IT & Management (HvA, 8.7)	Adjacent - not ID-specific
Experience in global Operations or Support environments (preferred)	KONGSBERG field service across Jordan, Oman, Azerbaijan; WDS Global support department	Partial
LMS / LXP familiarity (preferred)	Not explicitly cited; IT background covers platform integration	Minor

Gaps

Gap	Blocker?	Mitigation
Articulate 360 - no evidence	Moderate (70% of role is tool execution)	Demonstrate rapid tool mastery track record; self-study before interview; note comparable authoring tool experience
ADDIE model not cited by name	Soft (model used implicitly)	Name the model explicitly in cover letter; KONGSBERG thesis maps directly
No formal LMS administration experience	Soft (preferred only)	DevOps background covers platform infra; address lightly
Support org context	Soft (preferred)	KONGSBERG on-site support at oil rigs + WDS technical support management is legitimate analogy

C) LEVEL AND STRATEGY

Level detected: Mid-senior IC (3+ years stated minimum, program manager overlay). Christiaan is operating at a senior level relative to this spec - his experience building full learning labs dwarfs the "development phase only" remit.

Risk: This role is narrower than his natural operating level. The 70% execution focus (build content in Articulate 360) is below his ceiling. Program management at 30% is where he lives. There is a real risk of under-utilisation and ADHD-driven disengagement once the tooling is mastered.

"Sell senior without lying" plan:

- Lead with: "I've built the labs and the learning experiences inside them - not just the content, but the environments and the methodologies." Position the execution depth as intentional focus, not ceiling.
- Highlight KONGSBERG thesis as evidence of applying ADDIE/experiential design theory at a formal level.
- Reframe beer game redesign and blockchain minor as full-stack LXD projects - needs assessment, design, build, delivery, iteration.

"If they downlevel" plan: This is already at a level where comp risk applies - see Block D. Accept only if scope grows into program ownership within 6 months, and negotiate a clear review with expansion of the governance/strategy mandate.

D) COMP AND DEMAND

Item	Data	Source
Instructional Designer / LXD Amsterdam	€50,000-€75,000 gross/year mid-senior	Glassdoor NL, LinkedIn Salary
Program Manager overlay (tech scale-up)	+10-15% vs pure ID	Market norm
Adyen compensation reputation	Competitive but not top-quartile for non-engineering roles; known for good benefits	Glassdoor Adyen Amsterdam reviews
Christiaan's target	€65,000-€90,000	_profile.md
Fit to target	Role likely bands €55,000-€70,000 - bottom of target range	Estimated

Concern: The 70% execution / 30% PM split likely places this role below €70k in Adyen's levelling. Christiaan's floor is €55k. This could be tight; salary negotiation needed if offer comes.

E) CUSTOMIZATION PLAN

#	Section	Current status	Proposed change	Why
1	CV Summary	Broad innovation builder	Add specific line: "Designed and delivered simulation-based and game-based learning experiences across university, fintech training, and supply chain contexts"	Speaks directly to LXD execution history
2	KONGSBERG thesis entry	"simulation-based learning"	Add explicit mention of "adult learning theory and ADDIE-adjacent methodology"	Closes the ADDIE gap
3	Beer Game entry	Technical framing	Reframe as LXD project: needs → design → build → measure	Positions as full ADDIE cycle
4	Skills - Training Design	Listed as Expert	Add "Articulate 360 (in progress)" or similar; do not omit the gap	Honesty + signals fast learner
5	LinkedIn About	Generic	Add "I design learning experiences that make complex systems understandable - from blockchain simulations to AI lab onboarding"	Keyword match for Adyen's L&D search

F) INTERVIEW PLAN

#	JD Requirement	Story	S	T	A	R	Reflection
1	Execute ADDIE development phase	Beer Game Redesign	Windesheim needed modern supply chain simulation	Rebuild classic logistics simulation with contemporary teaching format	Applied experiential design methodology: analysis of learning gaps, content design, prototype, test with cohorts, iterate	Students and practitioners adopted it; demonstrator live at valuechainhackers.xyz	Should have documented the pedagogical framework more formally - retrofitting theory after the fact
2	Multimedia innovation / engagement	Blockchain Minor at InHolland	Need to make crypto understandable to non-technical students	Design and deliver full course "Build Your Own Crypto"	Created tangible objects + tokenomics simulations; game-based learning throughout	Course still running independently in 2026	Named the design approach more clearly would have eased handover
3	Stakeholder management / SME synthesis	KONGSBERG field deployments	Complex BI systems for BP/Statoil - oil engineers, not software people	Train site staff on new monitoring dashboards with zero tolerance for downtime	Simplified technical knowledge into on-site training; adapted format per audience	Deployments successful across Jordan, Oman, Azerbaijan	Language and cultural barriers surfaced that I hadn't prepared for - now I map audience context before building content
4	Managing multiple	COVID-19 Mega Project	Pandemic hit during active	Merge 8 courses into 1	Ran both tracks in	Delivered in under 2 months; became	Over-relied on my own

	workstreams	+ Spark! Living Lab simultaneously	lab operations; university needed emergency curriculum redesign	interdisciplinary simulation while keeping existing lab running	parallel using sprint-based management; daily standups with course leads	model for other departments	capacity; next time I would delegate earlier
5	Quality standards / version control	DevOps for lab environments	Multiple student cohorts using live tools; needed versioning	Implemented GitHub-based version control and CI/CD for all lab projects	Set up pipelines, container deployments, and update cadences	Zero unplanned downtime across 4+ years	Would implement monitoring- first next time rather than retroactively
6	AI for learning design	AI Stack Deployment at Windesheim	Students and researchers needed hands- on AI tooling - no budget	Self-funded and deployed Flowise, OpenWebUI, n8n, Supabase on own Linux infrastructure	Full stack: provisioning, container management, access control, onboarding guides	Active experimentation environment running; students working with real AI tools	Cost me personal money; should have written a formal grant application from the start

Recommended case study to present: Beer Game Demonstrator - live at demonstrator.valuechainhackers.xyz. It is a working simulation accessible in the browser, demonstrates full LXD cycle (problem, design, build, deploy, iterate), and directly addresses the "development phase" mandate in this JD.

Red-flag questions:

- "Do you have Articulate 360 experience?" - Answer: "I haven't used Articulate 360 specifically, but I've built interactive learning environments using digital authoring platforms and have the instructional design methodology to learn a new tool fast. My KONGSBERG thesis research was on simulation-based learning tools, and I've been building interactive learning experiences since 2018."
- "This role is very execution-focused - are you OK with that?" - Answer: "Yes, with clarity: the most impactful learning experiences I've built required deep execution focus, not just strategy. I have designed and built these from scratch. The 30% program management component is where I expect to also contribute ideas on methodology and tooling direction."

G) POSTING LEGITIMACY

Assessment: High Confidence

Signal	Finding	Weight
Posting age	First published 2026-03-30, ~7 weeks old at evaluation	Neutral (slightly long but normal for L&D specialist)
Apply button	Active via Greenhouse API (job returned full content)	Positive
JD specificity	Named tools (Articulate 360, ADDIE, Greenhouse infrastructure), org context (Support L&D), split (70/30)	Positive
Requirements realism	3+ years for mid-senior IC - realistic	Positive
Company hiring signals	Adyen is publicly listed, profitable, growing - no layoff signals in L&D	Positive
Reposting pattern	No prior appearance in scan history	Positive

Context Notes: Adyen's Support L&D is a real function supporting a large global operations org. The specificity of the JD (named tool, named phase of ADDIE, named division) suggests a real, scoped need.

RECOMMENDATION

Score: **3.4/5** - Below the "apply confidently" threshold. The role has genuine L&D alignment and Adyen is a quality employer, but three concerns push this down:

1. **Execution ceiling risk:** 70% of the role is building content in Articulate 360 - a tool Christiaan doesn't currently use. Steep learning curve before being productive.
2. **Under-utilisation risk:** His natural operating level is designing the lab and the methodology, not executing assets within an established framework.
3. **Office-first Amsterdam, full-time:** No remote option. Commute from Baarn is manageable (~40 min) but this is not part-time/fractional.

Recommendation: Apply only if Christiaan is specifically targeting Adyen as a company and is willing to invest time in Articulate 360 pre-interview. Otherwise, deprioritise in favour of roles with a build/design mandate (report 012 same company may be better fit).

H) CULTURE, PERSONALITY & LONG-TERM FIT

H1 - Org Culture Assessment

Stage and type: Large-scale public company (listed fintech, 4,000+ employees globally). The Support L&D team is a functional unit inside a global operations org. This is a corporate department, not a startup or innovation environment. Adyen has a genuine "engineered for ambition" culture, but that culture is primarily expressed through engineering and product teams. The Support L&D function is an enabling department - closer to the operational core than the innovation edge.

Culture signals: The JD language is execution-focused: "70% development phase," "quality standards," "operational workflow," "version control." The Adyen brand is strong and modern, but this specific role is positioned inside Support, not inside innovation or strategy. The hiring language emphasizes rigor and execution over vision and experimentation.

Physical/work environment: Office-first, Amsterdam. No remote option. Structured corporate office environment, not a lab or co-working space.

Match against 2-year vision: Christiaan's 2-year vision is a hackerspace: small group, building new things, high trust, new territory. This role places him inside a large corporate L&D department, executing ADDIE development cycles in an established methodology framework. The alignment with the hackerspace vision is minimal. This is the structural inverse of what he is optimizing toward.

H2 - Personality Fit Table

Dimension	What the role requires	Christiaan's profile	Match
Starter vs. finisher	Finisher-heavy: 70% is "development phase" execution within an established framework	ENFP-T starter, strongest 0 to 1	Poor
Variety vs. repetition	Iterative content production cycles, version control, operational consistency	Thrives on variety, depletes on repetition	Poor
Autonomy level	Execution within existing ADDIE framework and Adyen standards	Needs design and ownership mandate	Poor
Build vs. maintain	Build content assets within a defined system	Builder identity, maintenance depletes energy	Moderate (building assets, but not building the system)
Fractional fit	Full-time, office-first, Amsterdam. No fractional option indicated	Optimal: 2-3 concurrent 0.4-0.6 FTE	Poor - fractional conflict
Energy spike tolerance	Corporate L&D team; front-loaded energy may read as disruptive in a QA-focused environment	Front-loaded high energy in first weeks	Risky
Team size	Part of Support L&D team (size unknown, but inside a 4,000-person org)	Small team, high trust	Poor

Flags: Fractional conflict. Engagement risk (finisher-heavy role with no build-from-scratch mandate). Heavily process-constrained with no creative space outside content production.

H3 - Values and Mission Alignment

Adyen's mission (financial technology at scale, payments infrastructure) is commercially sound but not intrinsically motivating for Christiaan. The work he does for free - D&D campaigns, student counselling, guest lectures, 3D printing - shares no thematic connection with fintech payment operations support training. This role does not connect to the frontiers he gravitates toward (AI, sustainability, identity, education systems, community building). It is a transactional engagement: a well-paid execution role at a reputable company. He would not talk about this work unprompted at a dinner party. The L&D domain is genuine, but the domain-within-a-domain (support operations training at a payments company) is purely instrumental.

H4 - Energy Analysis

Energizers:

- Designing learning content has some creative component, particularly the multimedia and AI tooling mandate
- Adyen's reputation as a high-quality employer provides baseline motivation
- The 30% program management component touches stakeholder synthesis, which is energizing

Likely drains:

- 70% of the role is execution within Articulate 360 inside an established ADDIE framework: direct maintenance and repetition pattern
- Full-time Amsterdam office, single employer: direct conflict with the multi-engagement model that keeps Christiaan energized
- No innovation mandate, no building from scratch, no community activation
- Large corporate environment with no visible path to lab leadership or systems design
- Fintech support org context is far from the frontier domains (AI, sustainability, education innovation) that generate intrinsic energy

H5 - 18-Month Durability Test

Verdict: Plateau risk after initial tool mastery

Once Articulate 360 is learned and the Adyen content standards are internalized (likely 3-6 months), the role becomes a production cycle with no meaningful growth horizon. The 30% program management component offers some stability but is capped at operational governance, not strategic design. The role does not connect to the 2-year hackerspace vision and has no natural evolution toward lab leadership, innovation architecture, or fractional engagement. At 18 months Christiaan would either be seeking an exit or becoming visibly disengaged. This is a short-term engagement at best, not a sustainable track.

H6 - Personality-Specific Red Flags

Red flag	Present?	Severity	Context
Role is primarily maintenance/ops	Yes (70% execution in established framework)	High	Core of the role is content production, not system building
Solo sales of an unready product	No	N/A	Not applicable
Full-time exclusivity expected	Yes	Medium	Office-first, Amsterdam, no fractional option
Large corporate, slow decision cycles	Yes	Medium	4,000+ person org; Support L&D sits far from strategic decision-making
Governance/board role in declining org	No	N/A	Adyen is growing
Ceremony-only Scrum Master	No	N/A	Not an agile role

H7 - Fit Verdict

The honest case for this match:

The L&D domain is genuine and Christiaan has real instructional design credentials (KONGSBERG thesis, beer

game, Blockchain Minor). Adyen is a quality employer. The 30% program management component would be energizing. If Christiaan wanted to deepen the Articulate 360 toolset and build a formal corporate L&D credential, this role could serve as a stepping stone to a more senior L&D strategy role elsewhere.

The honest case against:

This role is 70% execution inside a tool Christiaan does not yet know, at a company in a domain (fintech payment support) that generates no intrinsic motivation, on a full-time office-first basis that directly conflicts with the fractional multi-engagement model. The starter profile hits a hard ceiling here within months. The content production cycle will deplete rather than energize. The corporate scale and Support-team positioning ensure slow decision cycles and low individual visibility. The cultural environment is the structural opposite of the hackerspace 2-year vision.

Note: Skill match was assessed at 3.4/5, but the personality/culture fit is genuinely poor. The overall score already reflects this accurately.

Overall personality/culture fit: Poor

KEYWORDS EXTRACTED

Learning Experience Design, Instructional Design, ADDIE model, Articulate 360, LXD, eLearning, adult learning theory, multimedia, LMS, LXP, AI-driven content, stakeholder management, program management, quality assurance, version control, support L&D, global operations, content development, authoring tools, learning portfolio

JOB DESCRIPTION (ARCHIVED)

Archived 2026-05-21 - original posting may be removed after offer closes

Title: Learning Experience Design Program Manager

Location: Amsterdam

Department: Support

Company: Adyen

First published: 2026-03-30

Requisition ID: JR_4464

This is Adyen

Adyen provides payments, data, and financial products in a single solution for customers like Meta, Uber, H&M, and Microsoft - making us the financial technology platform of choice. At Adyen, everything we do is engineered for ambition.

For our teams, we create an environment with opportunities for our people to succeed, backed by the culture and support to ensure they are enabled to truly own their careers. We are motivated individuals who tackle unique technical challenges at scale and solve them as a team. Together, we deliver innovative and ethical solutions that help businesses achieve their ambitions faster.

Learning Experience Design Program Manager, Support L&D

Adyen is looking for a creative and execution-focused Learning Experience Design Program Manager to join our Support Learning and Development team. This team focuses on L&D initiatives across our globally distributed merchant facing Support organization (Customer support, Technical support etc).

This role is dedicated to the "Development" phase of the ADDIE model, transforming high-level module outlines into engaging, high-quality learning experiences. You will be responsible for the end-to-end creation of learning assets, ensuring they are seamlessly integrated into our authoring tools and platforms. Beyond content creation, you will oversee the standards for learning methodologies, tooling, and innovation to ensure our learning products remain world-class. This position consists of a blend of deep instructional design expertise (70%) and operational program management (30%) to ensure efficiency and quality assurance across our global learning portfolio.

What you'll do

Learning Experience Creation - LXD

Content Development: Execute the "Development" phase of the ADDIE process by transforming module outlines into interactive learning assets, products, and experiences.

Authoring & Tooling: Build and configure learning solutions within authoring tools (e.g., Articulate 360) and other

digital mediums to ensure high-quality delivery.

Instructional Methodology: Select and apply the correct medium and instructional methodologies to create effective, learner-centric assets.

Multimedia Innovation: Incorporate innovative design trends and multimedia elements to enhance engagement and knowledge retention.

Program Management & Governance

Quality Standards: Oversee and maintain guidelines, templates, and quality assurance (QA) standards for all learning content design.

Operational Efficiency: Manage the operational workflow of the learning design process, ensuring projects are delivered on time and meet business requirements.

Tooling Strategy: Drive innovation in learning tooling and technologies, identifying new ways to improve the content creation process.

Stakeholder Management: Build and sustain relationships with Subject Matter Experts (SMEs) to translate technical information into digestible learning content.

Who you are

Qualifications

- BA/BS degree in Instructional Design, Learning & Development, Education, or a related field.
- 3+ years of experience in Instructional Design or Learning Experience Design, specifically focused on the development and execution phase of content creation.
- Advanced proficiency with eLearning authoring tools, particularly Articulate 360 (Rise and Storyline) as well as AI capabilities for Learning Design.
- Demonstrated experience using the ADDIE model and adult learning theories to build effective, agile scalable learning solutions.
- Strong organizational skills with the ability to manage multiple content development workstreams simultaneously.
- Experience managing a library of learning assets and maintaining version control across global teams.
- Ability to communicate effectively with stakeholders to synthesize complex ideas into clear learning content.

Preferred Qualifications

- Experience in a global Operations or Support environment.
- Familiarity with Learning Management Systems (LMS) and emerging learning technologies (LXP, AI-driven content tools).

Our Diversity, Equity and Inclusion commitments

Our unique approach is a product of our diverse perspectives. This diversity of backgrounds and cultures is essential in helping us maintain our momentum. Our business and technical challenges are unique, and we need as many different voices as possible to join us in solving them - voices like yours. No matter who you are or where you're from, we welcome you to be your true self at Adyen.

Studies show that women and members of underrepresented communities apply for jobs only if they meet 100% of the qualifications. Does this sound like you? If so, Adyen encourages you to reconsider and apply. We look forward to your application!

What's next?

Ensuring a smooth and enjoyable candidate experience is critical for us. We aim to get back to you regarding your application within 5 business days. Our interview process tends to take about 4 weeks to complete, but may fluctuate depending on the role. Learn more about our hiring process [here](#). Don't be afraid to let us know if you need more flexibility.

This role is based out of our Amsterdam office. We are an office-first company and value in-person collaboration; we do not offer remote-only roles.